Serasi Overview

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Summary

Serasi is a career-fit app that helps Malay youths aged 18–25 in Singapore find work that suits them, then links them to real openings, job tasters and internships. *Serasi* is Malay for "well-matched".

A youth takes a 15-minute quiz. Serasi scores every job out of 100 on interests, work style and values, explains the best matches, and opens live job searches and coaching. With consent, anonymised trends from many youths help MENDAKI plan events and job tasters that match what youths actually want.

A working demo exists today (private until shared). We propose a 300-youth pilot for about $22,000.

Why it's needed

Many youths start in jobs that don't fit them, and Malay youths get little guidance to choose well.

Figure	What it shows	Source
65%	of youths say they need more support with career planning	KPMG, NYC and IPRS youth poll, 1,000 youths, Nov 2025
36%	of polytechnic graduates in full-time jobs work outside their field five years after graduating	MOE parliamentary reply, May 2026 (Class of 2014)
44%	of Malay/Muslim youths feel they lack guidance, mentors or networks for their career goals	NYC survey in the MM Youth Taskforce report, 1,000 youths aged 15–35, 2026
15.5%	of Malay-Muslim workers studied for a job aligned with their current career	IPS study for SkillsFuture SG, 1,007 working-age adults, 2021–23
77%	of the same workers had never approached a career coach	Same IPS study

The last two figures cover working adults, not only youths; together they show how rarely people get guidance before they choose.

How Serasi works

A youth goes from quiz to real opportunities in four steps.

1. **Take the quiz.** Five short parts, about 15 minutes in all on a phone, using short validated forms of each test: interests, work style, values, three work scenarios, and a skills check. Youths who already have a three-letter code from MySkillsFuture can enter it and skip the interests part.
2. **Get scored.** Every job in the catalogue gets a fit score out of 100 from the three measures (see the next section).
3. **See matches.** The youth sees their profile (their top two interest types) and their top 10 jobs, each with plain-language reasons. Jobs that need a skill or qualification they don't have yet go to a separate "stretch" list, so they aren't lost. Ask Serasi answers follow-up questions.
4. **Take action.** Each job opens pre-filled searches on up to six job portals: MyCareersFuture for every role, plus Jobstreet, LinkedIn, FastJobs, Glints or Careers@Gov depending on the role. Youths can also book career coaching with NTUC e2i or M³+, see GRIT traineeships if eligible, and (proposed) join job tasters and internships through MENDAKI.

Search links are pre-filled searches only; nothing is scraped from the portals.

What it measures

Serasi combines three research-backed measures into one fit score for each job.

Measure	Weight	What it is	What the youth does	Why we use it
Holland RIASEC (interests)	50%	Psychologist John Holland's model of career interests. It sorts interests into six types, and every job has a three-letter code (e.g. data analyst = ICE). Used by MySkillsFuture and O*NET.	Rates 30 activities from 1 to 5 (the O*NET Mini Interest Profiler), e.g. "Finding the pattern in a messy dataset"	Interest–job fit predicts job performance across 92 studies (Nye et al., 2017)

Measure	Weight	What it is	What the youth does	Why we use it
Big Five (work style)	30%	The most-researched model of personality: openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness and emotional stability, plus honesty-humility from the HEXACO model	Rates about 20 statements (a short Big Five form plus honesty items), e.g. "I finish my work before I relax", then picks what they'd do in 3 workplace scenarios	Conscientiousness predicts performance across occupations (Barrick and Mount, 1991); a Malay-language version keeps the five-factor structure
Work values	20%	What a job must offer for someone to feel satisfied and want to stay	Picks up to 3 of 8 values, e.g. financial stability, work–life balance, room to learn	Person–job fit relates to satisfaction and lower intent to quit across 172 studies (Kristof-Brown et al., 2005)

The six interest types

Each youth's top two types become their profile, such as Investigative–Enterprising (Analyst–Persuader).

Type	Nickname	Enjoys	Example jobs
R · Realistic	Builder	Hands-on work with tools	Technician, engineer
I · Investigative	Analyst	Solving hard problems	Data analyst, researcher
A · Artistic	Creator	Designing and creating	UX designer, video editor
S · Social	Carer	Helping and teaching	Nurse, teacher
E · Enterprising	Persuader	Leading and persuading	Sales, marketing
C · Conventional	Organiser	Order and clear systems	Accounts, operations

How the fit score adds up

Fit score = 50% × Interests + 30% × Work style + 20% × Values

Example from the demo: data consultant scores 68 on interests, 97 on work style and 75 on values, so 34 + 29.1 + 15 = 78 out of 100. The 50/30/20 weights are a starting point; the pilot will recalibrate them against job satisfaction and staying.

Youths can also set optional personal preferences, such as avoiding interest-based banking or wanting halal food options at work. These flag roles or add questions to ask employers; they never change the score.

Not used for scoring: MBTI, DISC and the Enneagram (weaker evidence; coaching use only), and horoscopes or numerology (no evidence).

Ask Serasi (AI explainer)

Ask Serasi is a built-in AI chat that explains a youth's results in plain English or Malay. It explains; it never decides or changes a score.

What youths can ask:

- Why a job is their top match, e.g. "Why is data consultant my top match?"
- What a job involves day to day
- Which skill to build first for a stretch role
- Their profile explained in Bahasa Melayu

Each job card also has an "Ask Serasi about this job" link.

Guardrails:

- It sees only the youth's scores and shortlist, never a name or contact details.
- It answers from the app's job data and widely known facts, and says when it isn't sure.
- It never quotes salaries or vacancy numbers; it points to MyCareersFuture for pay and live openings.
- It doesn't label people or claim more than the scores show.
- For personal advice or worries, it suggests a career coach at NTUC e2i or M³+.

In the demo, Ask Serasi runs on the viewer's own Claude account and asks permission before the first question. A full build would use an AI service under PDPA consent; running costs for 300 youths should fit within the hosting budget.

Insights for MENDAKI

Every youth who takes Serasi, with consent, adds to an anonymised picture of what Malay youths want from work, which MENDAKI can use to plan events that fit.

1. **Youths take Serasi** at MENDAKI events, in schools and campuses, or online, after giving PDPA consent.
2. **MENDAKI sees the trends** on a dashboard of grouped counts: the most common interest types, the jobs youths shortlist, the values they pick and the skills they want to build, by age, school and area.
3. **MENDAKI plans events that fit**, such as job tasters and internships in the fields youths shortlist most, drawing on MENDAKI's Professional Networks (over 1,000 members across 13 sectors).

Examples: a cohort that leans Creator could get a design and media job-taster day; one that leans Carer, healthcare and social-service attachments. Common skills gaps can shape workshops.

Safeguards: MENDAKI sees only grouped counts, never names or individual answers, and any group smaller than about 10 youths is hidden so no one can be identified.

Job tasters work. In 2025, NYC offered about 11,000 job-taster opportunities with around 35 partners, and 78% of participants said they were more aware of pathways to their career goals (MCCY, Jul 2026).

Promotion

Three draft posters for campuses, community centres and MENDAKI events, each with a QR code to the quiz:

- "Which of the six are you?" (the six interest types)
- "Your first job should fit you" (free, 15 minutes)
- "Try a job before you choose it" (job tasters and internships with MENDAKI)

Suggested Malay slogans: *Kerjaya serasi, masa depan berseri* and *Kenali diri, temui kerjaya*.

Design principles

Five rules keep Serasi safe, fair and trusted.

- **Evidence first.** Only research-backed measures, and every weight is tested in the pilot.
- **Guidance only.** Results open up options. They are never used by employers to screen or hire, because self-report tests can be gamed when stakes are high.
- **No labels.** Strengths-based language throughout, and no filtering by gender, race or background. The MM Youth Taskforce found youths dislike being labelled as disadvantaged.
- **Privacy by design.** Data is collected with PDPA consent, youths can delete it at any time, and partners see only anonymised, grouped data.

- **People in the loop.** Every result can be talked through with a counsellor or coach; the hand-off to NTUC e2i, M³+ or school counsellors is part of the design.

Pilot plan

We propose a pilot with 300 youths for about $22,000: prepare until March 2027, run the pilot from April to June 2027, track every youth for 12 months, and decide by mid-2028 whether to scale, merge into a partner's platform, or stop.

Pilot in mid-2027, then 12 months of tracking before a decision



pilot timeline · 4 phases, Nov 2026 to Jun 2028

Every youth has check-ins 6 and 12 months after the pilot. The phases are drawn at equal width, not to scale.

Draft budget

Item	Detail	Cost (SGD)
Thank-you vouchers	300 youths × $20 at the pilot, plus $10 at each of two check-ins	$12,000
Outreach and workshops	Promotion, posters and sessions	$3,000
Malay translation	Professional translation and testing with 20 youths	$2,500
Career guidance adviser	One adviser's honorarium	$1,000
Hosting and PDPA review	Low-cost cloud hosting plus a one-off security and PDPA review	$1,500
Buffer	10% contingency on the $20,000 subtotal	$2,000
Total		**$22,000**

All figures are draft estimates to replace with quotes. Not costed: the team's own build time, and counsellor time and venues from partners. Funding routes to explore: the NYC Young ChangeMakers grant and MENDAKI's Malay/Muslim Community Development Fund through a partner organisation.

Success measures: job satisfaction, intention to stay and supervisor ratings at 6 and 12 months; reliability of at least .70 per scale and a 4–6 week retest. If Serasi does no better than MySkillsFuture plus a counsellor, we partner instead of building.

Partners and our ask

MENDAKI sits at the centre: it reaches youths, hosts events and uses the insights. None of these partners has been approached yet; they are proposals.

Partner	Role in Serasi
MENDAKI	Reach youths through programmes and events; use the insights to plan job tasters with its Professional Networks
National Youth Council (NYC)	Job tasters and mentoring
NTUC e2i and M³+	Career coaching and job matching
SkillsFuture SG and Workforce Singapore	Skills data, the Skills Framework and MyCareersFuture
ITE, polytechnics and universities	Pilot recruitment and career counsellors

What we are asking MENDAKI for:

1. Help to reach 300 youths for the pilot
2. About $22,000 in seed funding
3. A career guidance adviser
4. Links to employers for job tasters and internships

Serasi could also serve as the assessment step in DISCOVER, the career exploration platform launched by the MM Youth Taskforce, rather than as a separate app.

Status and limitations

The demo shows the whole journey, but its data and scores are illustrative and not yet validated.

What the demo does today:

- Runs the five-part quiz with shortened question sets, or loads one of three fictional sample profiles
- Scores 43 hand-coded roles and shows the top 10, stretch roles and reasons
- Opens pre-filled searches on six job portals, plus coaching and GRIT links
- Lets viewers adjust the 50/30/20 weights to see how rankings change
- Includes Ask Serasi, tested so far with a stand-in for the AI

Still to do or validate:

- **Role data.** The full build would draw job profiles from O*NET, linked to Singapore's SSOC codes and the SSG Skills Framework, instead of 43 hand-coded roles.
- **Weights and reliability.** The 50/30/20 weights and every scale need testing in the pilot.
- **Ask Serasi.** Real AI answers need checking for accuracy in English and Malay before youths use it.
- **Evaluation.** Without an independent evaluator, the team would assess its own pilot; an academic supervisor could provide a check.
- **Partners and budget.** No partner has been approached, and all costs are estimates.
- **Cause.** That poor fit is a main reason youths leave jobs is a hypothesis; fit is one factor among several, alongside pay, workplace culture and discrimination.

Sources

- KPMG, NYC and IPRS: Gen2050 youth poll (Nov 2025)
- MOE: Tracking graduate employment alignment to field of study (May 2026)
- MM Youth Taskforce full report, with the NYC Survey on Malay/Muslim Youth (2026)
- IPS study of Malay-Muslim workers for SkillsFuture SG: project summary
- MCCY: Job taster programmes for youths (Jul 2026)
- MCCY: Efforts to strengthen inter-generational mobility for the Malay/Muslim community (Jul 2026)
- M³+: Employment and employability
- NYC Young ChangeMakers grant
- Research on the measures: Nye et al. (2017) on interest fit; Barrick and Mount (1991) on the Big Five; Kristof-Brown et al. (2005) on person–job fit